



**INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY
MADRAS**

BS in Data Science & Applications

SPG Project May 2026

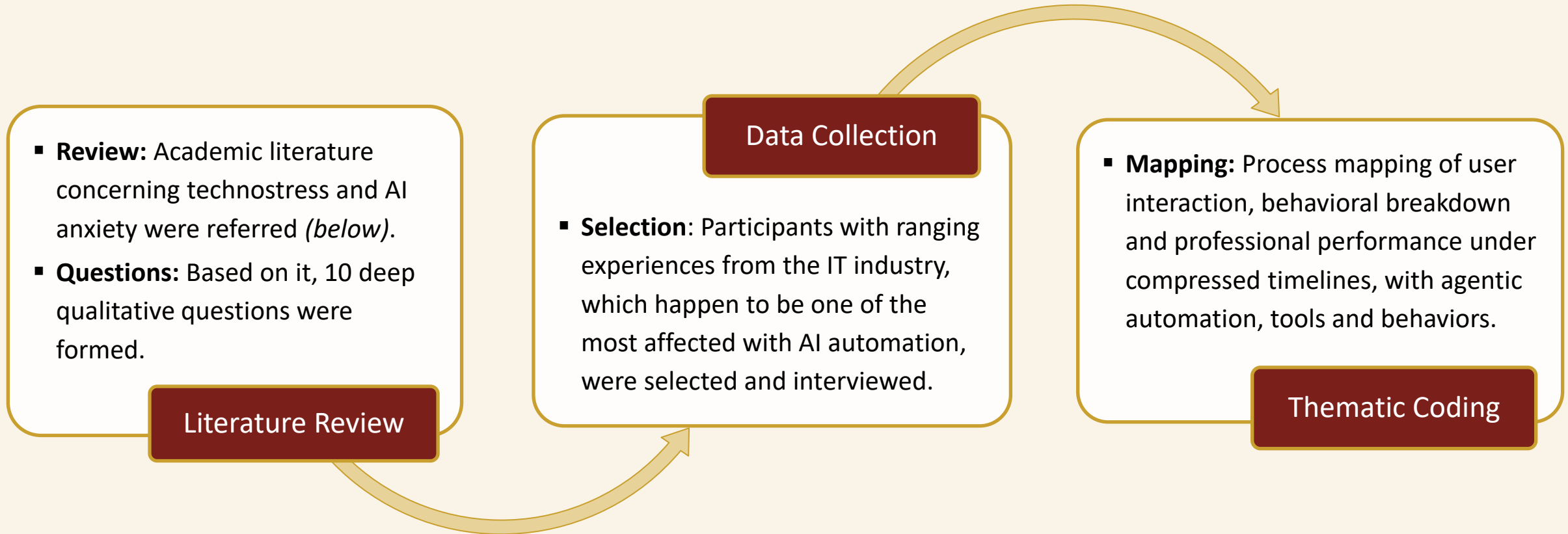
GP-2 SUBMISSION

Navigating Algorithmic Anxiety

Evaluating the Role of a Growth Mindset in Managing Workplace Stress and Skill Obsolescence in the Age of Generative AI.

Methodology, Analysis & Recommendations, Influence Model, Project Review & Closure

Team Number	Team 52
Project Title	Navigating Algorithmic Anxiety
Domain	Resilience • Technological Literacy • Lifelong Learning • Stress Management • Growth Mindset
Submission Date	25 th July 2026



- Reich et al. (2026), *Psychological Safety as the Key to AI Transformation* (arXiv) <https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.23279>
- Sinha & Sharma (2025), *Artificial Intelligence and the Perception of Workplace Stress* (IJIP) <https://ijip.in/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/18.01.083.20251302-1.pdf>
- Xu et al. (2023), *AI Awareness and Employee Depression* (IJERPH) <https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph20065147>
- Zheng (2025), *AI Awareness and Emotional Exhaustion* (Behavioral Sciences) <https://doi.org/10.3390/bs15040401>



Analysis & Key Findings

Systemic Realities of AI integration in Enterprise Workflows

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Baseline Deadline Acceleration

The Root of Technostress

AI drastically compresses routine task execution, it elevates performance baseline rather than freeing up time, leading to workplace pressure.

Growth Mindset as a Buffer

Avoiding the Two Extremes

Anxiety leads to two extremes blind reliance and total resistance. Growth mindset balances AI speed with human oversight.

Human-in-the-loop

Un-delegatable Liability

While AI can do a substantial portion of routine tasks, AI algorithms cannot assume legal or operational liability. Human oversight is irreplaceable.

AI as a Curiosity Multiplier

The Learning Engine

Rather than viewing automation as a skill replacement, a growth mindset leverages easy access to information to stimulate deeper technical curiosity and learning.

Continuous Learning for Agency

Neutralizing Job Insecurity

Workplace stress reaches its peak when professionals feel helpless against rapid technological shifts. Adaptability is the key.

Anchoring Security in Human Differentiators

Beyond Tool Fluency

Anxiety subsides when professionals realise that career security is anchored in non automatable human qualities: critical thinking, ethics & domain specific judgement.

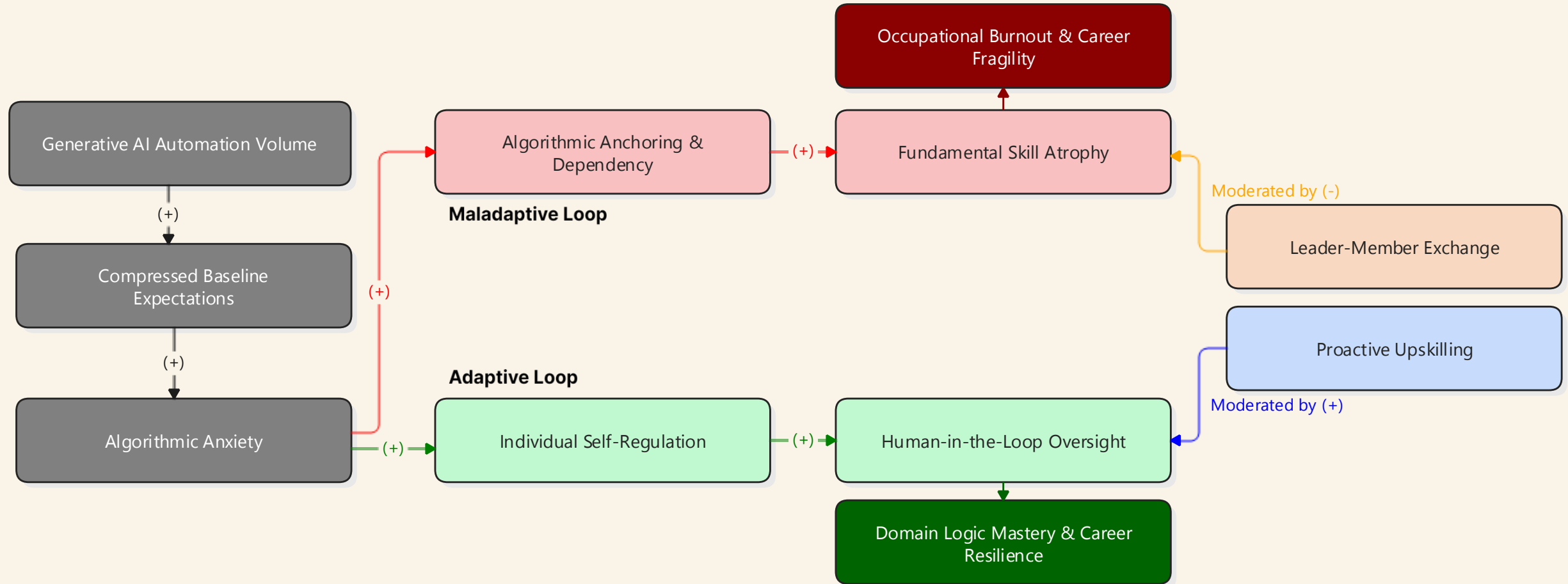


Recommendations

For organizations and individuals

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Target Audience	Core Focus Area	Actionable Recommendations
Individual Professionals	Parallel Upskilling & Parallel Execution	<i>Leverage GenAI for rapid execution/prototyping while intentionally maintaining parallel manual practice of fundamental logic to avoid skill atrophy and platform dependency.</i>
Individual Professionals	"Junior Teammate" Mental Model	<i>Adopt a self-regulation framework that subjects all AI-generated outputs to strict human-in-the-loop validation, auditability, and contextual alignment before deployment.</i>
Managers & Leaders	Outcome & Token-Aware Evaluation	<i>Restructure performance metrics to evaluate final quality, domain logic, and cost-efficiency (token spend) rather than judging tool adoption optics alone.</i>
Organizations	Cognitive Load & Baseline Adjustment	<i>Realign project deadlines to prevent chronic burnout; ensure productivity gains from AI are re-invested into employee upskilling rather than compounding workplace stress.</i>



Legend: (+) = Direct/Increases | (-) = Buffers/Reduces



Project Review & Closure

Credits, Challenges and Ending Notes

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Member	Contributions
Rishi Jain (21f1002476)	Idea Proposal, Interviews, Draft Interview Questions & Reports, Final Submissions
Harsh Vardhan (24f1002285)	Idea Proposal, Interviews, Final Submissions
Shrinidhi Kumar (23f1002153)	Idea Proposal, Interviews, Final Submissions
Ashirwad (23f2000650)	Idea Proposal, Interviews, Final Submissions
Hariom Kumar (23f2004225)	Idea Proposal, Interviews, Final Submissions

Challenges

- **Filtering Algorithmic Hype:** Isolating specific, timestamped workplace behaviors from generalized industry commentary about Generative AI.
- **Cross-Domain Synthesis:** Unifying insights across contrasting roles (e.g., frontline software engineers vs. product management leads) into a single cohesive behavioral model.

Best Practices

- **Timestamped Verbatim Coding:** Directly linked every insight to exact transcript timestamps to ensure data fidelity and verifiability.
- **Multi-Tier Perspective Sampling:** Paired frontline individual contributors with managerial decision-makers to capture both operational execution and evaluation metrics.

"AI does not replace human intellect; it elevates performance baselines. A growth mindset buffers technostress by channeling algorithmic anxiety into technical curiosity—anchoring career resilience in non-automatable human accountability, domain logic, and critical judgment."